

Clever Clicker - User Manual

Unity Editor Tool

Quickly select overlapping objects in the Scene view

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1. Introduction

What is Clever Clicker?

Clever Clicker is a Unity Editor tool that makes selecting overlapping objects effortless. When multiple objects occupy the same screen position, a simple modifier key + click reveals all objects at that point in an intuitive popup menu.

Key Benefits

- Select any object regardless of overlap or obstruction
- Visual highlighting shows exactly what you're selecting
- Works with 3D objects, 2D sprites, and UI elements
- Keyboard navigation for rapid selection
- Customizable modifier key and highlight color
- Zero setup required - works immediately after import

Core Concepts

Popup Menu - A context menu that appears showing all objects at the click position, sorted by distance from camera.

Object Highlighting - Visual wireframe feedback showing the bounds of the currently hovered object.

Modifier Key - The key you hold while clicking to activate Clever Clicker (Alt by default).

Design Philosophy

Clever Clicker is designed to:

- Integrate seamlessly with Unity's existing selection workflow
- Be completely non-intrusive when not in use
- Provide immediate visual feedback
- Work with any object type in any render pipeline
- Require zero configuration to start using

Unity Version Support

- Minimum: Unity 2021.3 LTS
- Recommended: Unity 2022.3 LTS or later
- Tested: 2021 LTS, 2022 LTS, 2023 LTS, 2024+

Compatible with all render pipelines: Built-in, URP, and HDRP.

2. Getting Started

Installation

Unity Package Manager

1. Download the Clever Clicker package
2. In Unity, go to Assets > Import Package > Custom Package
3. Select the downloaded package
4. Click Import to import all files

Verify Installation

1. Open Unity
2. Check that Tools > Clever Clicker > Settings menu appears
3. The tool is now active - no further setup needed

Quick Start

Step 1: Activate

1. Position your mouse over objects in the Scene view

2. Hold **Alt** (or your configured modifier key)
3. **Click** with the left mouse button

Step 2: Select

1. A popup appears showing all objects at that position
2. **Hover** over items to see them highlighted in the scene
3. **Click** an item to select it

Step 3: Done

- The object is now selected in Unity
 - Press **Escape** or click outside the popup to cancel
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3. Using the Popup

Popup Interface

When you activate Clever Clicker, a popup menu appears showing:

Header

- Shows total object count
- Click to select ALL objects at once

Object List

- Each object shows its icon, name, and primary component
- Objects sorted by distance from camera (nearest first)
- Scrollable when many objects are present

Navigation Methods

Mouse Navigation

- Hover over items to highlight them
- Click to select
- Scroll wheel to browse long lists

Keyboard Navigation

- **↑/↓ Arrow Keys** - Move through the list
- **Enter** - Select the highlighted object
- **Escape** - Close without selecting

Closing the Popup

The popup closes when you:

- Select an object
- Press Escape
- Click outside the popup
- Click in another Unity window (Inspector, Hierarchy, etc.)

Select All Objects

Click the header row ("Select All Objects (X)") to select every object in the list simultaneously. Useful for:

- Multi-object editing
 - Grouping operations
 - Bulk property changes
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4. Object Highlighting

How Highlighting Works

When you hover over an object in the popup list, Clever Clicker draws a visual indicator in the Scene view showing that object's bounds.

Highlight Elements

Wireframe Box

- Shows the object's bounding box
- Drawn in your configured highlight color
- Includes a subtle glow effect

Crosshair

- Marks the center of the object
- Scales with camera distance for consistent visibility
- Helps locate small or distant objects

Subdivided Grid

- Appears on very large objects (planets, terrain, large buildings)
- Provides visual reference when zoomed in close
- Automatically adjusts based on apparent screen size

Supported Object Types

Clever Clicker highlights:

- **3D Objects** - MeshRenderers, SkinnedMeshRenderers
 - **2D Sprites** - SpriteRenderers
 - **UI Elements** - RectTransforms, Canvas elements
 - **Objects without Renderers** - Shows crosshair at transform position
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5. Settings

Access settings via: **Tools > Clever Clicker > Settings**

Modifier Key

Options: Alt, Control, Shift, Command

Choose which key activates Clever Clicker. Consider:

- **Alt** (Default) - Doesn't conflict with most Unity shortcuts
- **Control** - Familiar modifier key
- **Shift** - Easy to reach
- **Command** - Mac-friendly option

Selection Behavior

Select Only (Default)

- Selects the object
- Doesn't change Scene view camera

Select and Focus

- Selects the object
- Frames the object in Scene view (like pressing F)
- Good for navigating large scenes

Highlight Color

Click the color picker to choose your wireframe highlight color. Consider:

- Bright colors for dark scenes
- Contrasting colors for your project's palette
- High saturation for visibility

Default: Yellow-orange (#FFCC33)

Excluded Layers

Select Unity layers to ignore. Objects on excluded layers won't appear in the popup.

Use for:

- Ignoring background/environment layers
 - Filtering out UI when working on 3D
 - Hiding debug visualization layers
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6. Tips & Best Practices

Workflow Integration

Dense Scenes

- Use Clever Clicker to pierce through overlapping props
- Combine with Unity's isolation mode for focused work
- Exclude background layers to reduce clutter

UI Work

- Easily select nested UI elements
- Works with all Canvas render modes
- Highlights show actual RectTransform bounds

Large Objects

- Zoom in close - the grid highlight helps orientation
- The crosshair remains visible at any zoom level
- Use "Select and Focus" to quickly jump to objects

Modifier Key Selection

Choose based on your workflow:

- If you use Alt+Click for camera orbit: Use **Control** or **Shift**
- If you use Ctrl+Click for multi-select: Use **Alt** or **Shift**
- If you're on Mac: **Command** may feel natural

Performance

Clever Clicker is optimized for large scenes:

- Only processes objects at click point
 - Highlight rendering is lightweight
 - No impact when not actively used
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7. Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Popup Doesn't Appear

Symptom: Modifier + Click does nothing

Solutions:

1. Verify modifier key in Settings
2. Check you're clicking in Scene view (not Game view)
3. Ensure objects exist at click position
4. Check excluded layers aren't filtering everything

Object Not in List

Symptom: Expected object doesn't appear in popup

Causes & Solutions:

- Object is on excluded layer → Check Settings
- Object has no collider AND no renderer → Object must be pickable
- Object is hidden → Check visibility in Hierarchy

Can't Select Through Mesh

Symptom: Only front object appears, not objects behind

Solution: This should work automatically. If not:

- Ensure back objects have colliders, OR
- Ensure back objects are pickable via mesh

Highlight Not Visible

Symptom: Hovering doesn't show wireframe

Solutions:

1. Check highlight color contrast with scene
2. Object may be off-screen (look for crosshair)
3. Very small objects may need zoom

Popup Closes Immediately

Symptom: Popup appears then vanishes

Cause: Clicking outside popup bounds

Solution: Click is registering outside - try clicking more centered on objects

Error States

"No objects found"

- Click position has no pickable objects
 - All objects at position are on excluded layers
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8. Technical Reference

Detection Methods

Clever Clicker uses multiple detection methods to find objects:

1. **Physics Raycast** - 3D colliders
2. **Physics2D Raycast** - 2D colliders
3. **HandleUtility.PickGameObject** - Mesh-based picking (iterative)
4. **Bounds intersection** - SpriteRenderers
5. **RectTransform containment** - UI elements

This comprehensive approach ensures nearly any object can be selected.

Data Storage

Settings Storage: EditorPrefs

Stored settings:

- Modifier key preference
- Excluded layer mask
- Focus on select toggle
- Highlight color

Settings persist across:

- Unity sessions
- Project switches
- Editor updates

Compatibility

Render Pipelines

- Built-in Render Pipeline: ✓
- Universal Render Pipeline (URP): ✓
- High Definition Render Pipeline (HDRP): ✓

Editor Platforms

- Windows ✓
- macOS ✓
- Linux ✓

Note: Clever Clicker is editor-only. No runtime components are included or needed.

File Location

The script should be placed in an **Editor** folder:

Assets/Editor/CleverClicker.cs

Or anywhere with `#if UNITY_EDITOR` wrapping (included by default).

Credits & Attribution

Clever Clicker for Unity Version 1.0.0

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For support and feature requests: cheekychopslabs@gmail.com

Thank you for using Clever Clicker!